FPFL User Guide

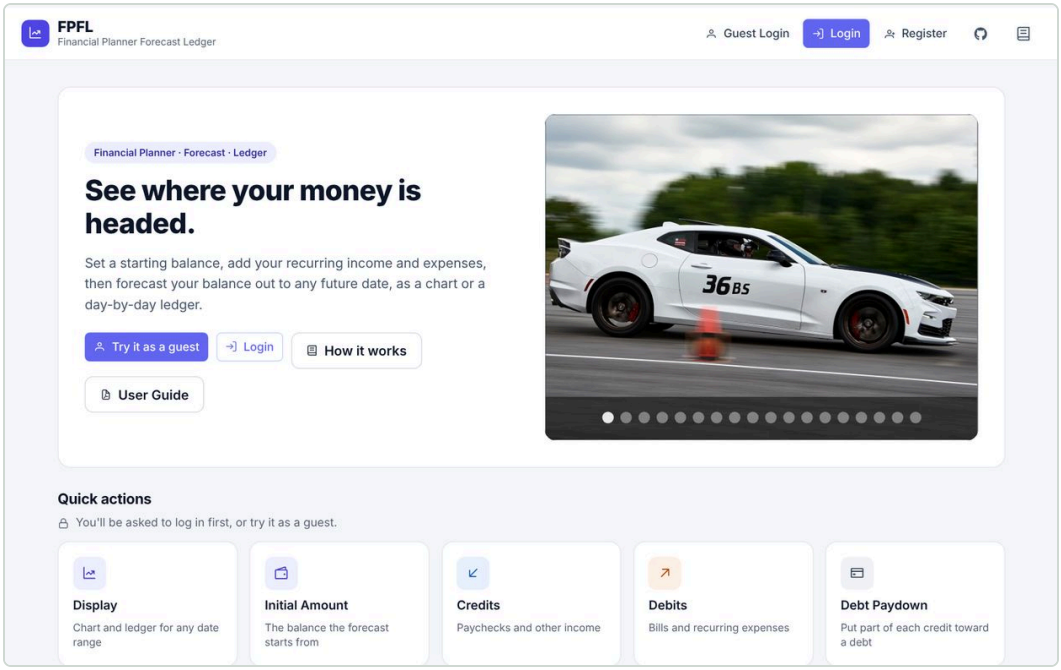
November 8, 2026 · Rick Donalson · ui-ng.ledger-finance.com

FPFL (Financial Planner Forecast Ledger) forecasts your account balance day by day: enter a starting balance, your income (credits) and expenses (debits), add any credit cards or loans, pick a date range, and see where your balance will be — as a chart, a ledger, or an Excel workbook.

Getting started

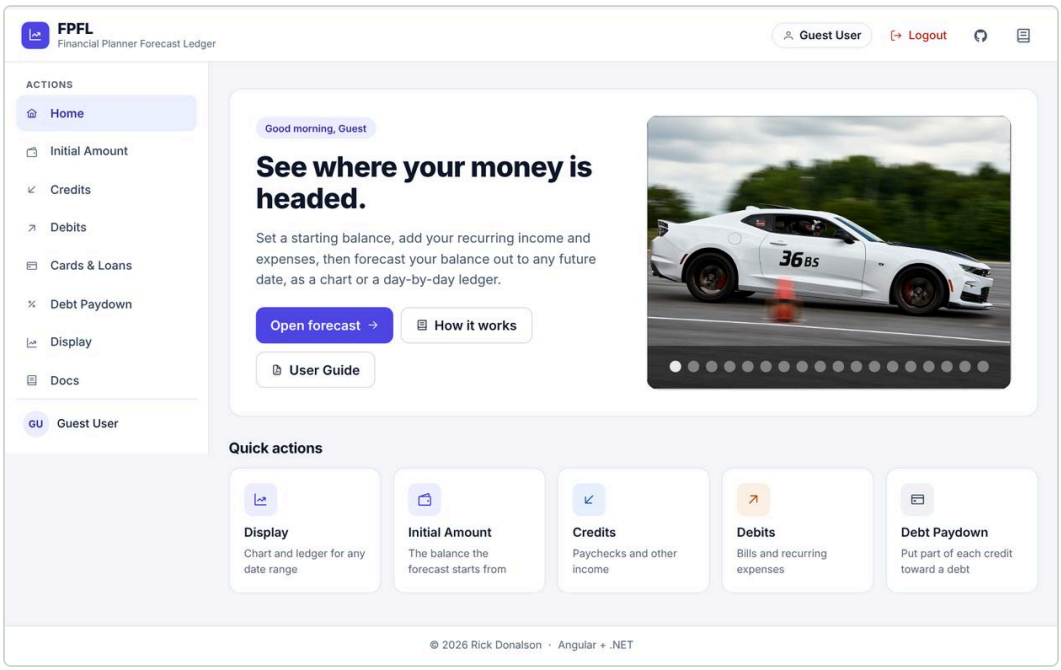
Open **ui-ng.ledger-finance.com** and sign in from the top bar or the home page.

- **Guest Login** (or **Try it as a guest**) signs you in to a shared demo account with sample credits, debits and a credit card. No password needed.
- **Login** signs in to your own account; **Register** creates one (name, email, password).
- Your session renews itself while you work. Shortly before it would expire, a dialog offers **Stay logged in**.



The home page before signing in

Once you're signed in, the menu on the left lists every page and highlights the one you're on (admins also see an **Admin** section with Item Types, Time Periods and System Status). The home page has a button for the main pages, and the top bar shows your name, **Change Password** (not for the guest) and **Logout**. On a narrow screen the menu folds away behind the ☰ button.



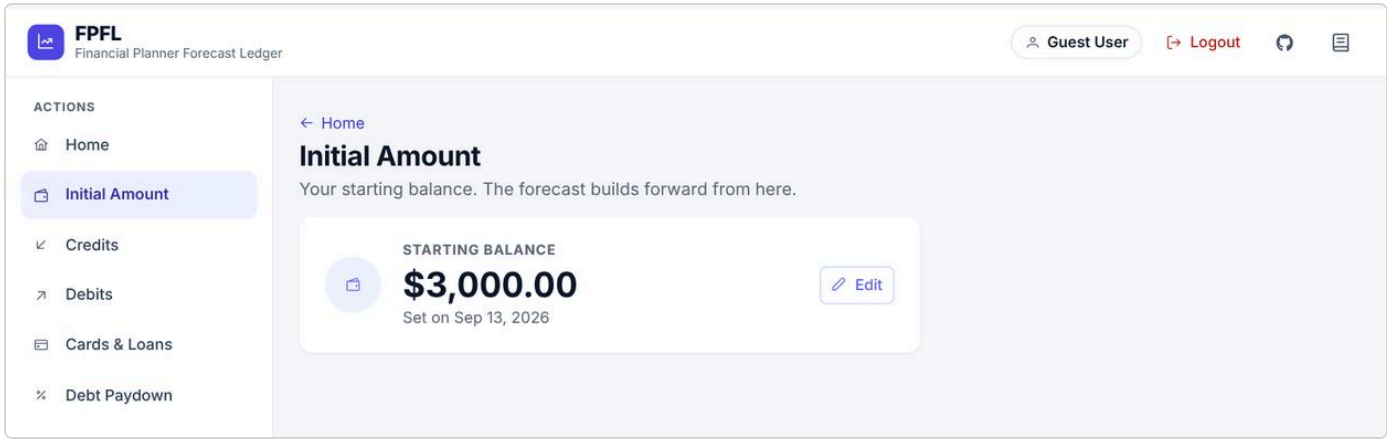
The home page after signing in, with the menu on the left

A good order the first time: set your **Initial Amount**, add your **Credits** and **Debits**, add any **Cards & Loans**, then open **Display** to see the forecast.

Initial amount

Your initial amount is the balance the forecast starts from — usually what's in the account today. Every account gets one automatically at $0.00, so there's nothing to create.

1. Open **Initial Amount** from the menu or the home page.
2. Select **Edit**, type the new balance, and select **Save**.
3. The card shows the new amount and the date you set it.

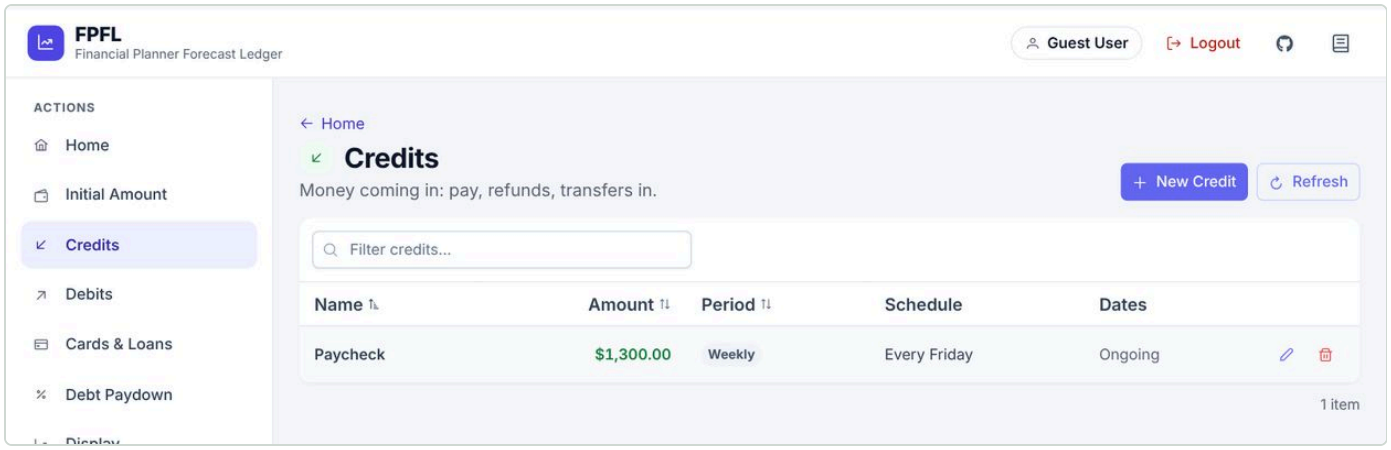


The Initial Amount page

Update it whenever you reconcile your account, so the forecast starts from a true number.

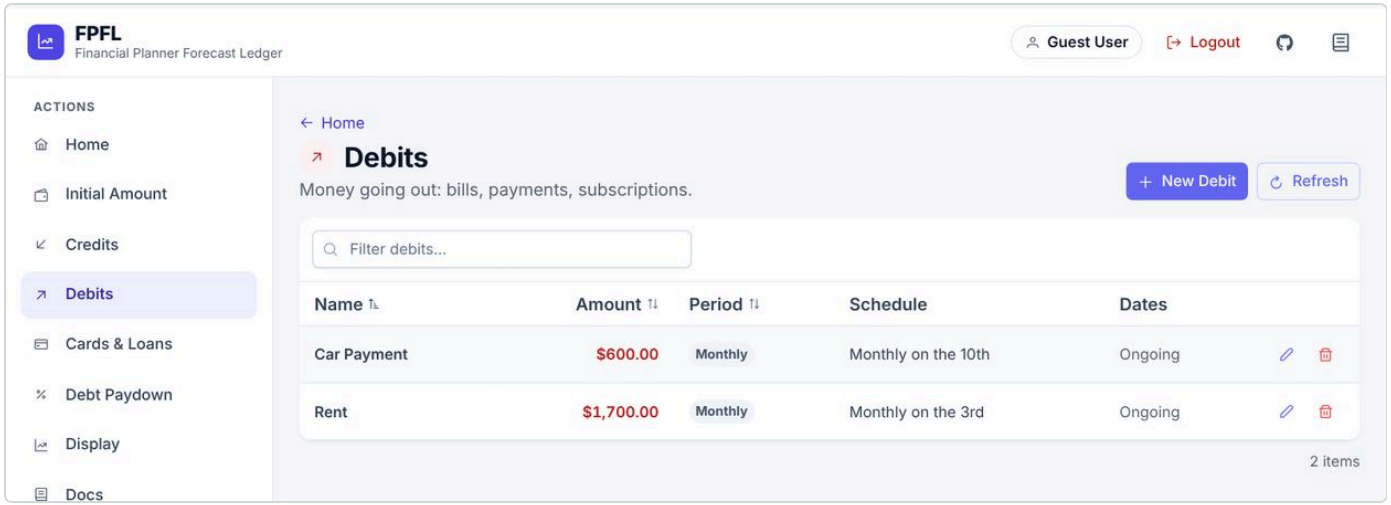
Credits and debits

Credits are money coming in (pay, refunds, transfers in); **debits** are money going out (rent, bills, payments, subscriptions). Both pages work the same way.



The Credits list

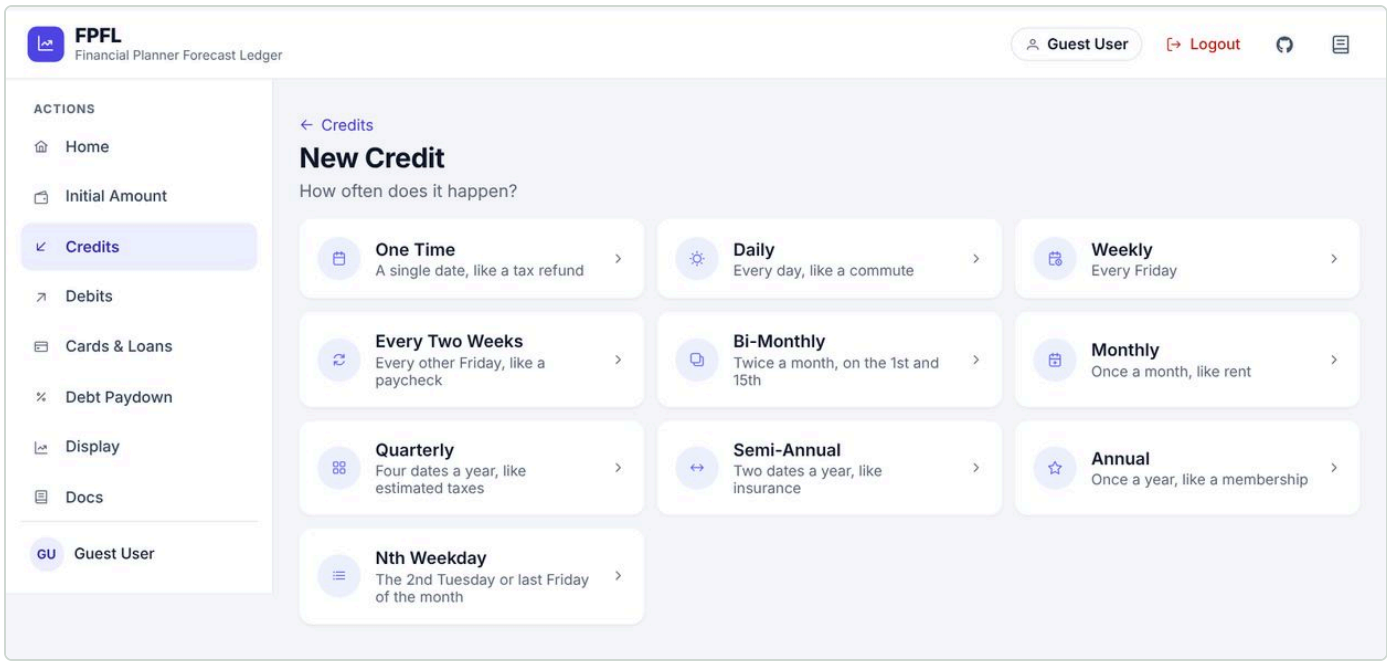
- Each row shows the name, amount, time period, a plain-English schedule ("Every Friday", "Monthly on the 10th") and its dates.
- Type in **Filter** to narrow the list; select a column heading to sort.
- The pencil edits an item; the trash can deletes it after you confirm.



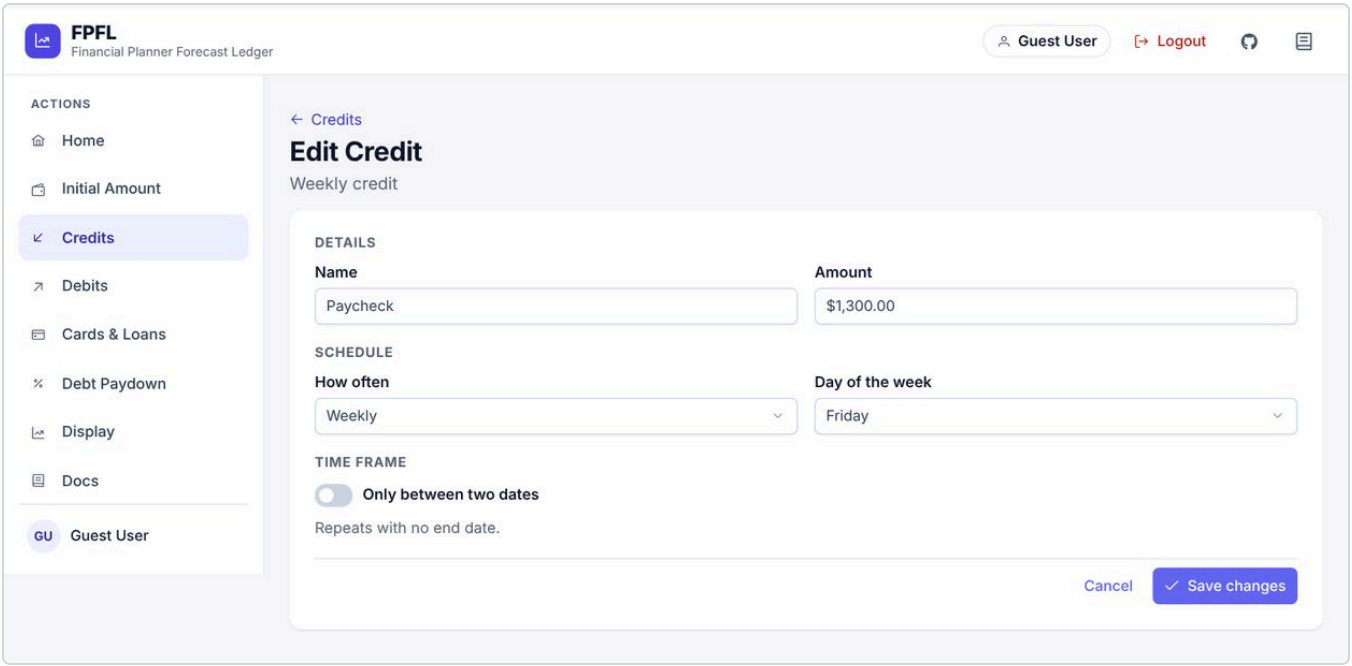
The Debits list

To add one

1. Select **New Credit** (or **New Debit**).
2. Pick how often it happens. Each card gives an example.
3. Fill in the name, amount and the schedule fields for that period, then select **Add credit** (or **Save changes** when editing).



Choosing how often a new credit happens



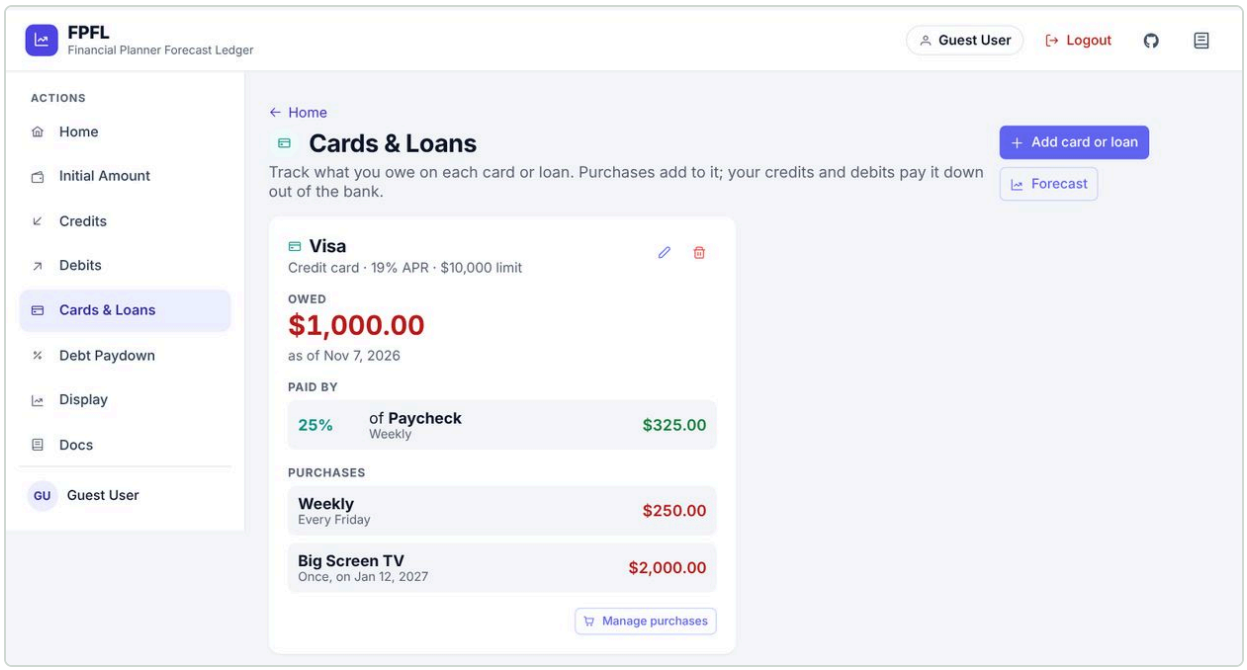
A Weekly credit: a $1,300 paycheck every Friday

Time period	You choose	Example
One Time	A date	A tax refund
Daily	—	A commute
Weekly	A day of the week	Every Friday
Every Two Weeks	A day of the week and the first date	A paycheck every other Friday
Bi-Monthly	Two days of the month	The 1st and 15th
Monthly	A day of the month	Rent on the 3rd
Quarterly	Four month/day pairs	Estimated taxes
Semi-Annual	Two month/day pairs	Insurance
Annual	A month and day	A membership
Nth Weekday	Which week and weekday	The 2nd Tuesday or last Friday

A day past the end of a short month lands on its last day: "the 31st" is April 30, and Feb 29 is Feb 28 outside leap years. Turn on **Only between two dates** (**Stop on a date** for Every Two Weeks) to limit when an item applies.

Cards & Loans NEW

Cards & Loans keeps each credit card or loan as its own account. Purchases go on the card and raise what you owe; payments from your credits and debits pay it down and come out of the bank forecast; interest is charged monthly. Display then shows each balance day by day and when it will be paid off. In the guest account, a **Visa** owes $1,000 at 19% APR with a $10,000 limit, takes $250 of purchases every week plus a $2,000 TV in January, and is paid by a quarter of every paycheck.

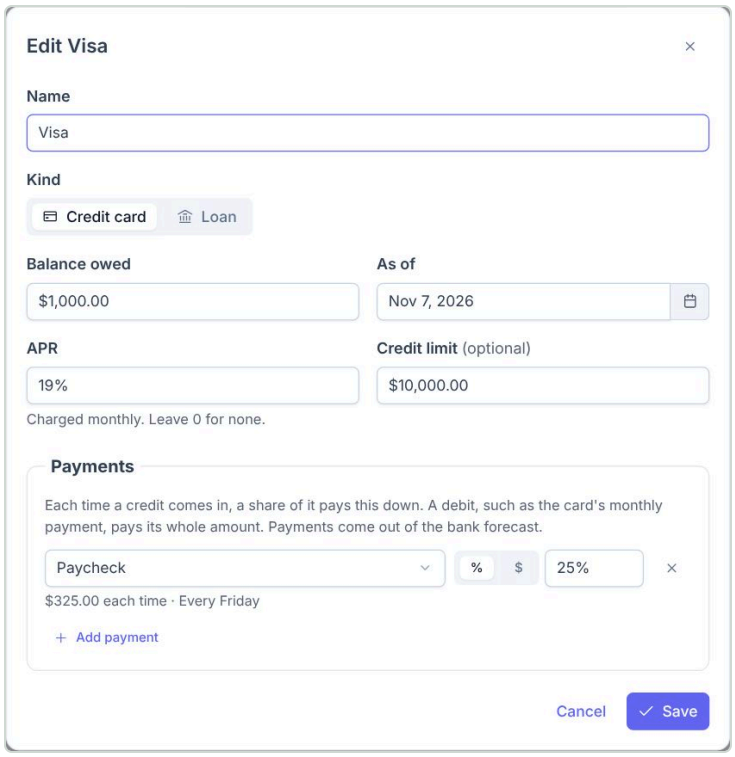


The Cards & Loans page

Each card shows what's owed and as of when, the APR and limit, who pays it and its first purchases. The pencil edits it and the trash can deletes it (with its purchases) after you confirm. **Manage purchases** opens the account's own page; **Forecast** takes you to Display.

To add a card or loan

1. Select **Add card or loan** and give it a name.
2. Choose the **Kind**: **Credit card** or **Loan**. Only a card has a credit limit.
3. Enter the **Balance owed**, the date it was true (**As of**), the **APR** (0 for none; interest is charged monthly), and for a card an optional **Credit limit**.
4. Under **Payments**, select **Add payment** and choose a credit or a debit:
   - A **credit** (such as a paycheck) sends a share each time it comes in: a percentage (**%**) or a fixed amount (**$**). The line underneath shows the dollars sent ("$325.00 each time").
   - A **debit** (such as the card's own monthly payment) pays its whole amount.
5. Select **Save**.

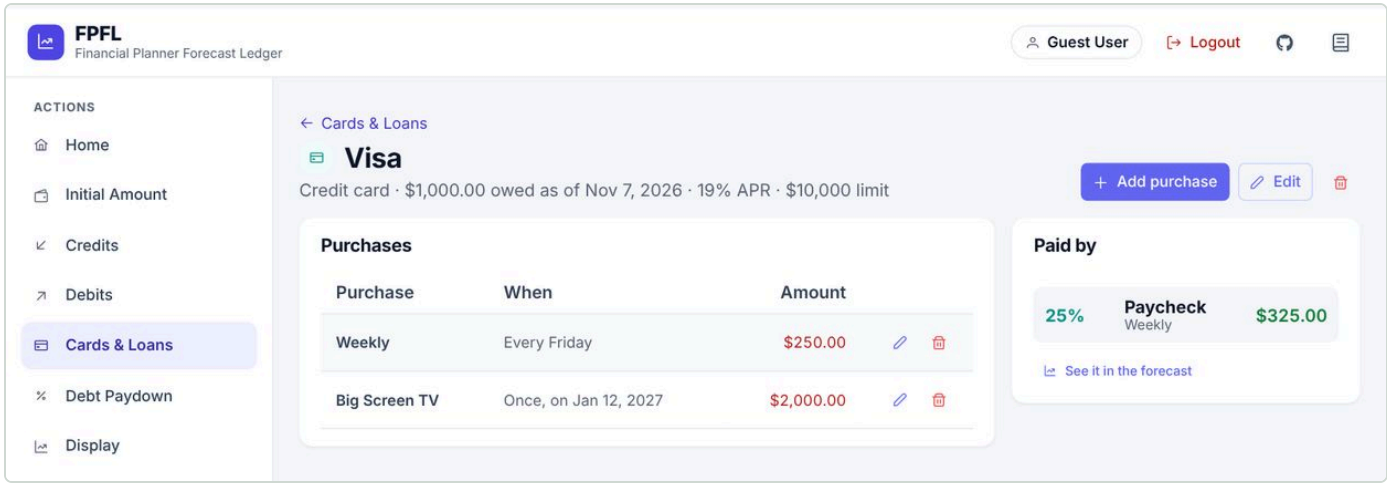


Editing a card: a quarter of every paycheck goes to it

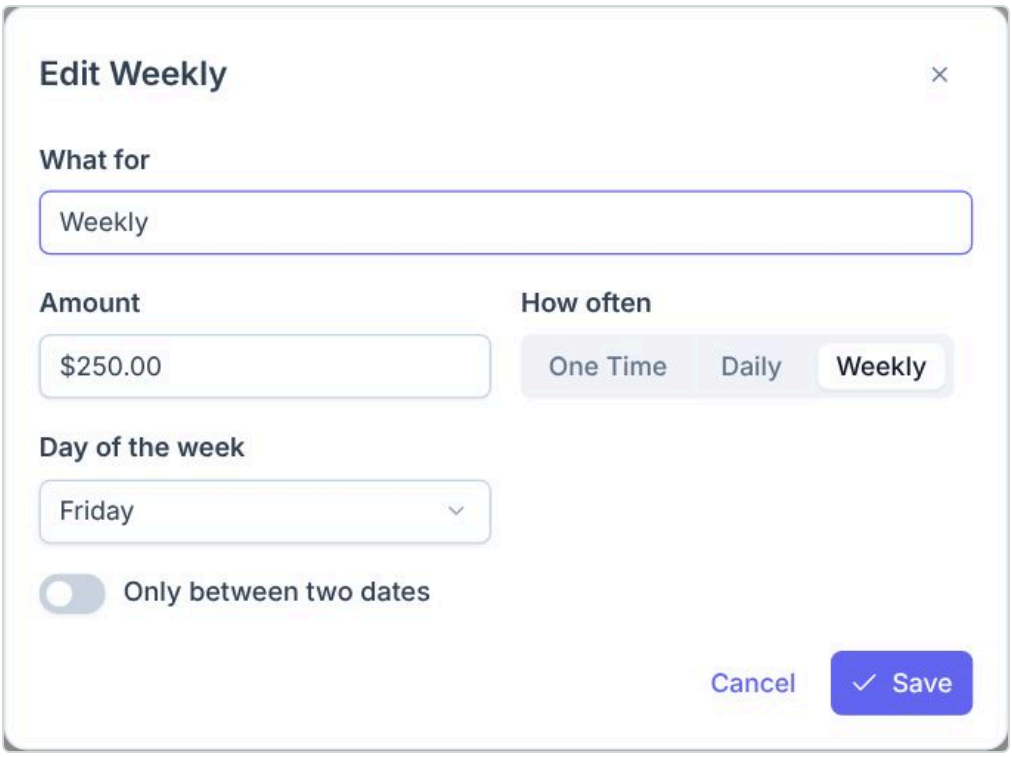
A credit can't be split more than 100% across all your cards and loans; if you try, the dialog says how much is left.

Purchases

On an account's page, **Add purchase** records something you buy on it: what it was for, the amount, and how often (**One Time**, **Daily** or **Weekly**, with the date or day of the week). Turn on **Only between two dates** to limit a repeating purchase to a date range. The pencil edits a purchase and the trash can deletes it; **Edit** at the top changes the account itself.



The Visa's page with its purchases and payment

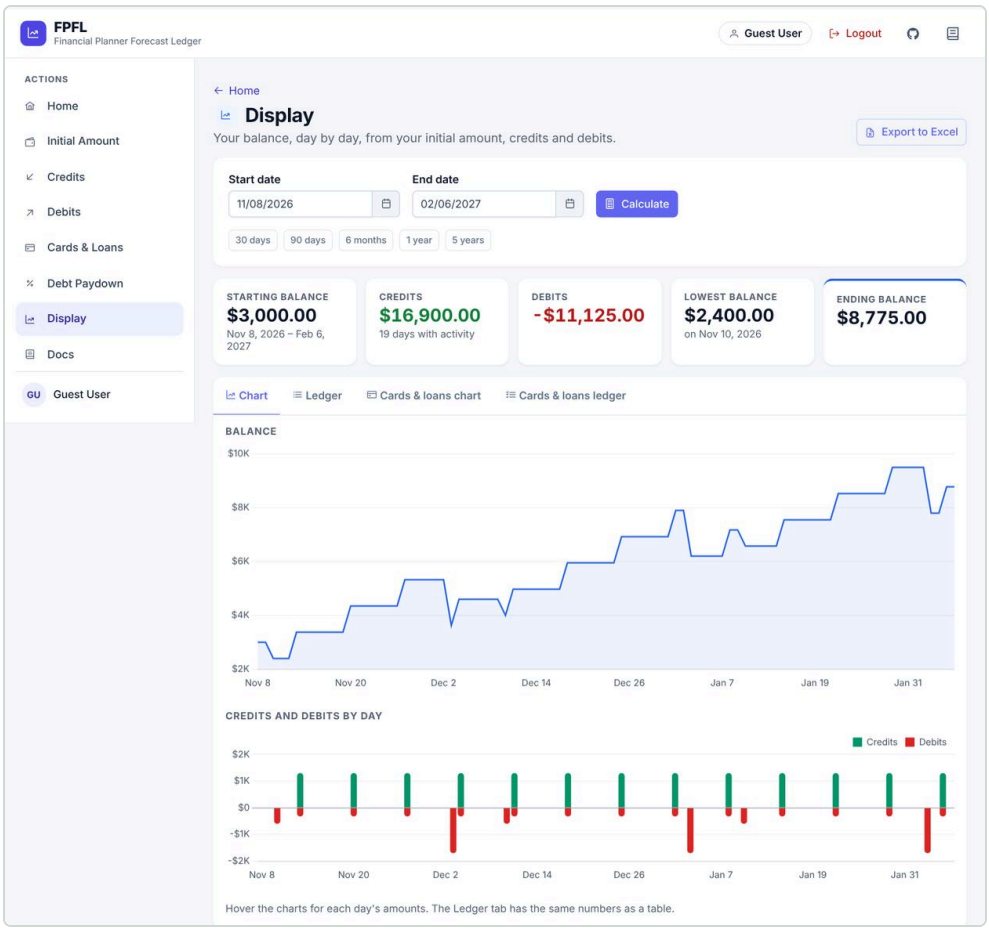


Editing a purchase: $250 every Friday

Display: your forecast

Display shows your balance day by day. It opens with the next 90 days already calculated.

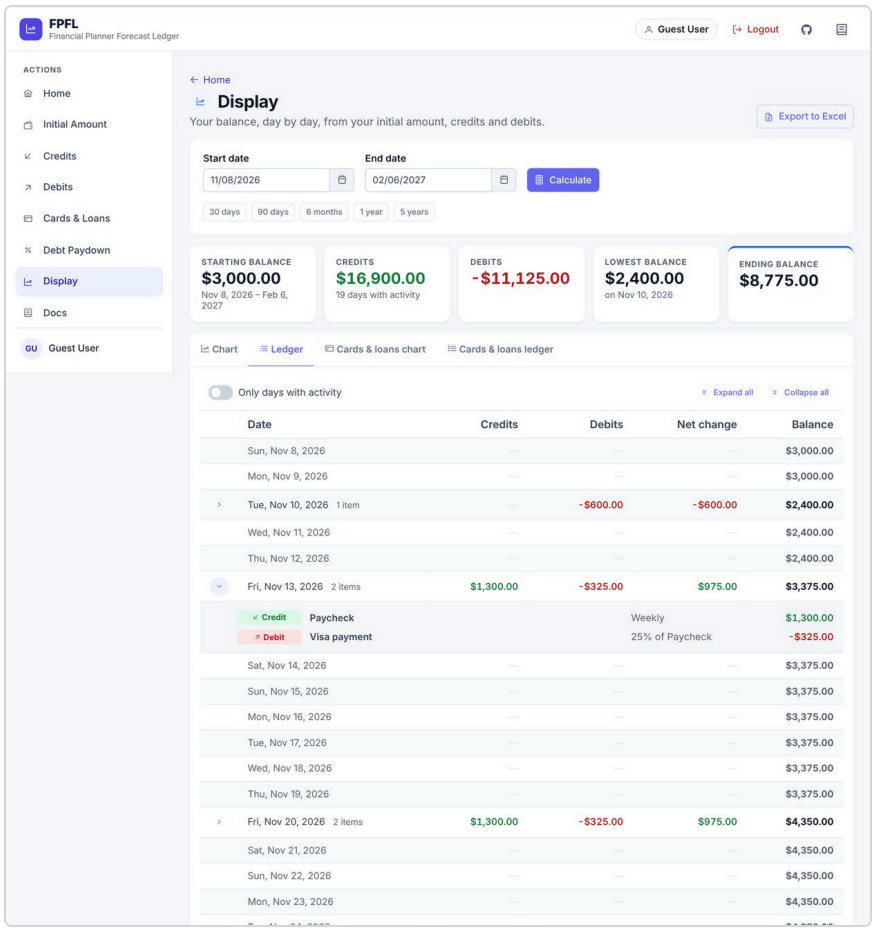
1. Change **Start date** and **End date**, or select a quick range (30 days to 5 years), then **Calculate**. A forecast can cover up to 10 years.
2. Read the summary tiles: starting balance, total credits and debits, your lowest balance and the day it happens, and the ending balance. A warning appears if the balance ever drops below $0.
3. Use the tabs below for the details.



The Display page: summary tiles and the Chart tab

Chart — the top chart is your balance over time; the one below shows each day's credits (green, above zero) and debits (red, below). Hover for the exact amounts.

Ledger — one row per day with credits, debits, net change and balance. Select the arrow on a day to see its items, or **Expand all**. **Only days with activity** hides the quiet days. A payment to a card or loan shows as a debit named after it, such as "Visa payment, 25% of Paycheck".

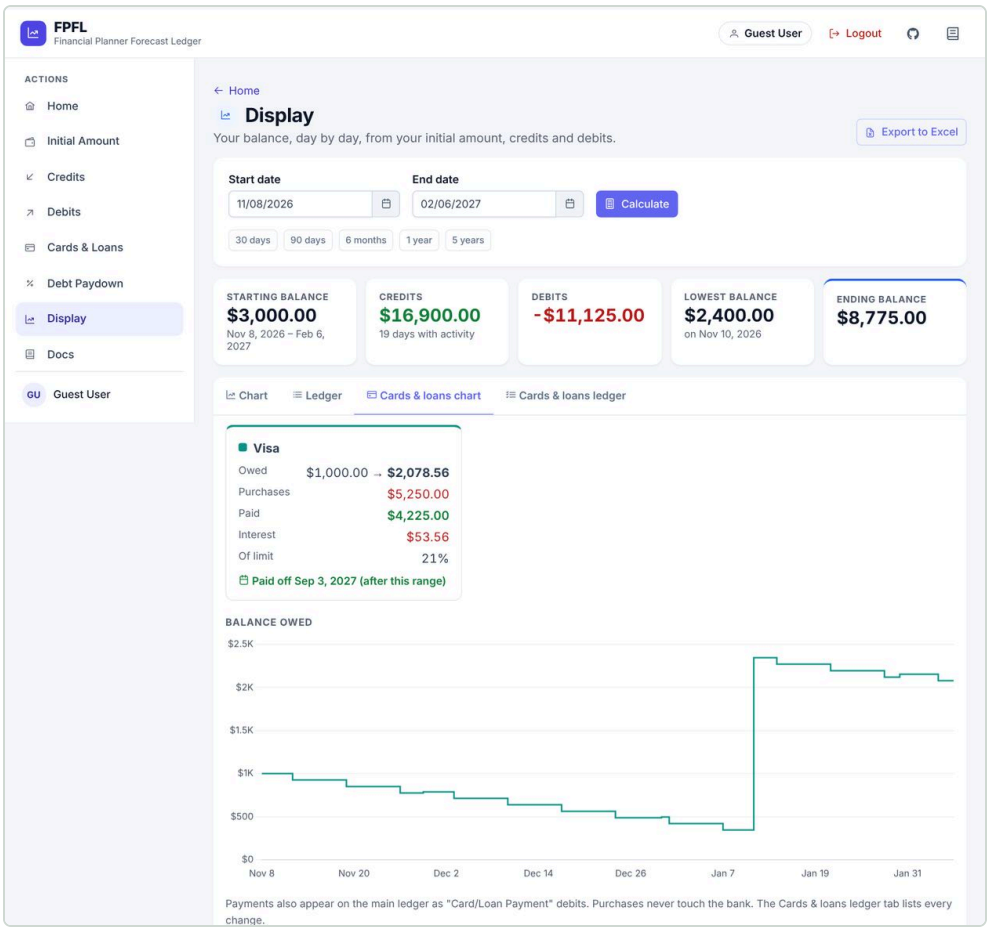


The Ledger tab with Nov 13 expanded: the paycheck and the quarter of it sent to the Visa

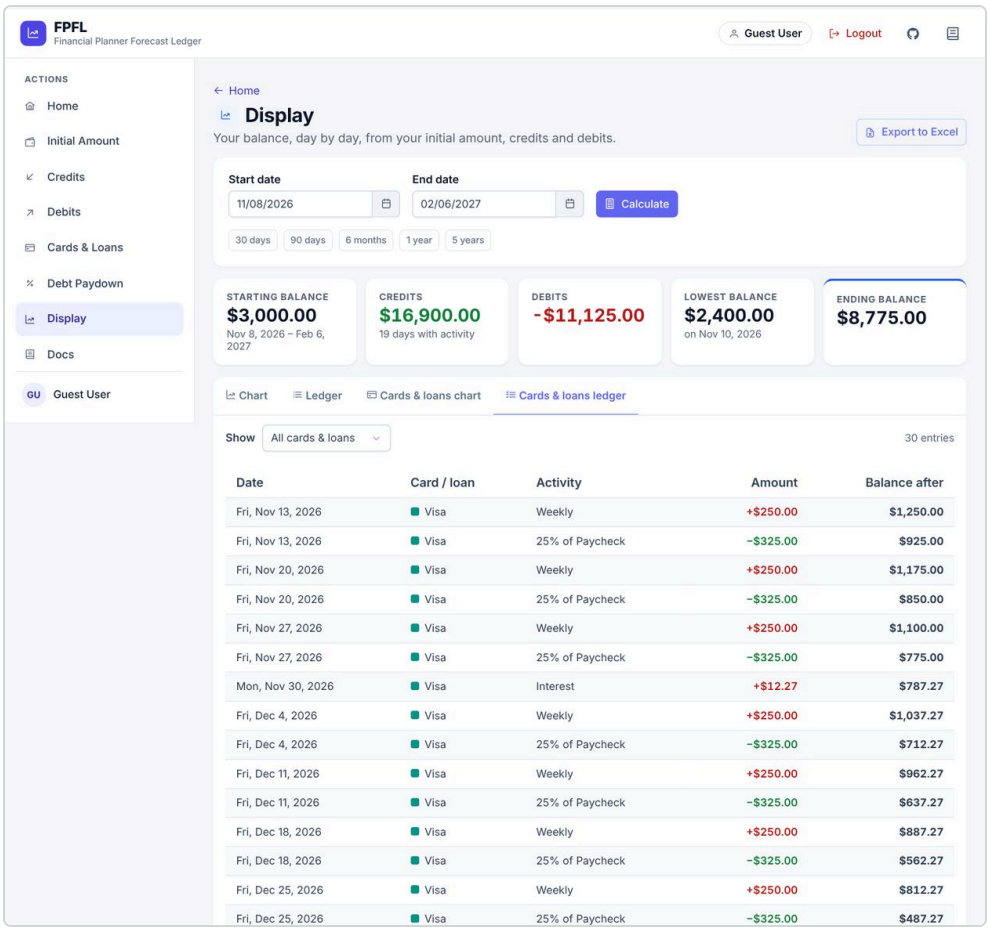
Cards & loans tabs NEW

Once you have a card or loan, two more tabs appear.

- **Cards & loans chart**: a summary per account (owed at the start and end of the range, purchases, paid, interest, limit used, and the payoff date) above each balance over time.
- **Cards & loans ledger**: every purchase (+), payment (–) and interest charge, with the balance after it. **Show** filters to one account.



The Cards & loans chart tab: the Visa falls $75 a week, jumps with the TV in January, and is paid off on Sep 3, 2027



The Cards & loans ledger tab

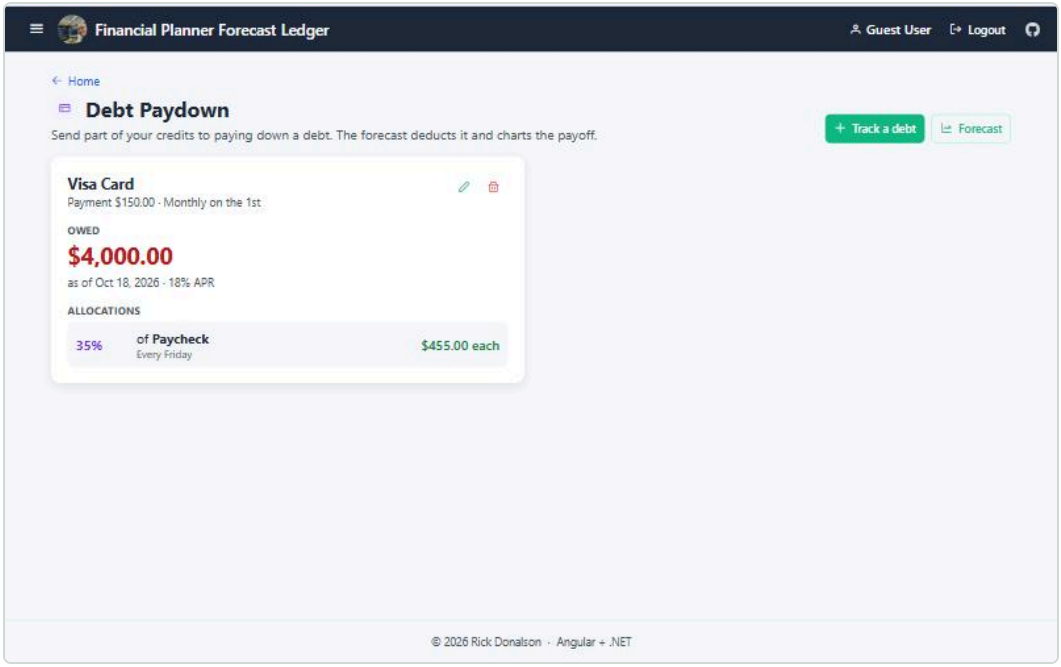
If a balance won't be paid off within 30 years at the current rate, its summary says so; add a payment or raise a share.

Export to Excel

Export to Excel (top right) downloads the forecast as a workbook laid out like the ledger: each day's items sit in a collapsed group you open with Excel's **+** button, or open all at once with the **2** button at the top left. With cards or loans there's a **Cards & Loans** sheet, and with tracked debts a **Debt Paydown** sheet.

Debt Paydown

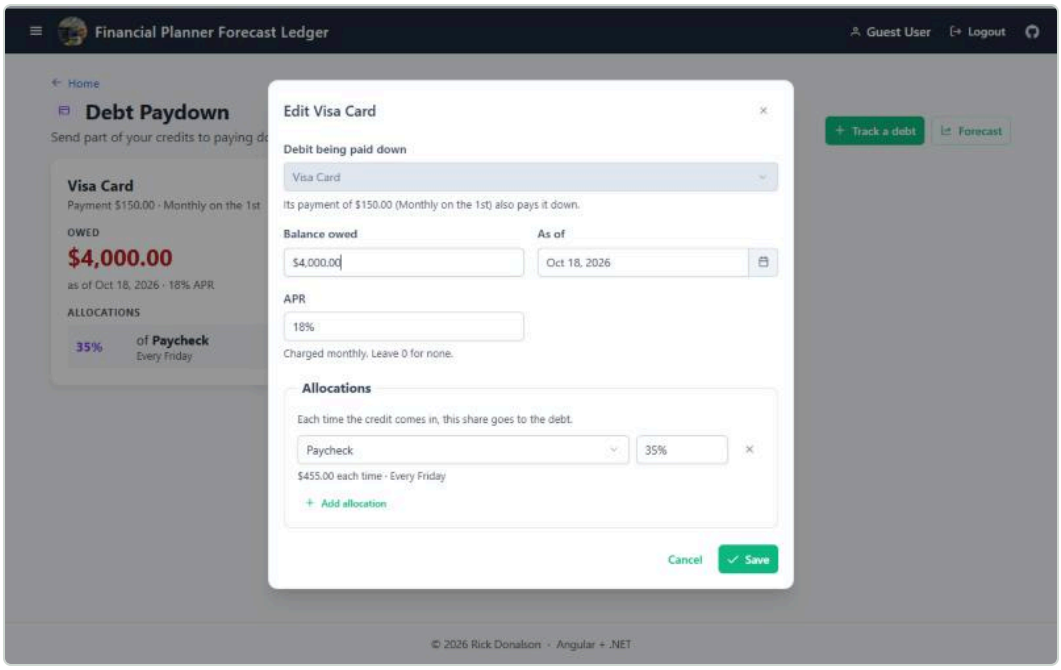
Debt Paydown is the simpler, older way to follow a debt: it tracks a debit you already pay and sends a percentage of your credits toward it. Cards & Loans does all of this and also records purchases, so use it for new cards. The pictures below use an example Visa Card: $4,000 owed at 18% APR, a $150 monthly payment, and 35% of each paycheck.



The Debt Paydown page

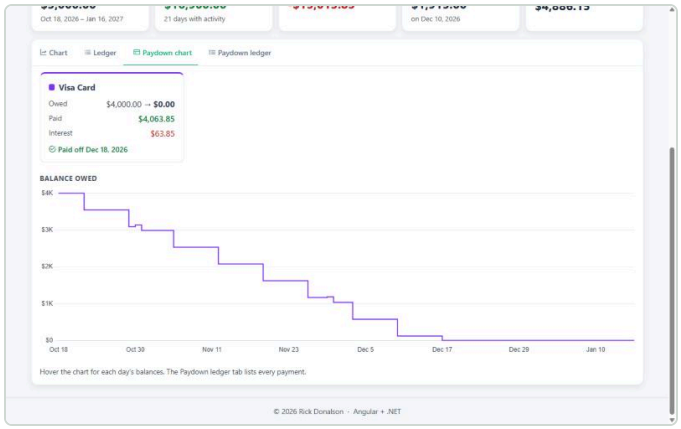
To track a debt

1. Add the debt's regular payment as a debit first (for example "Visa Card, $150 monthly").
2. On **Debt Paydown**, select **Track a debt** and choose that debit. Its own payment also pays the debt down.
3. Enter the balance owed, the date it was true (**As of**), and the **APR** (0 for none; interest is charged monthly).
4. Select **Add allocation**, choose a credit and a percentage. The dialog shows the dollars sent each time. Add more credits the same way.
5. Select **Track debt** (or **Save** when editing).

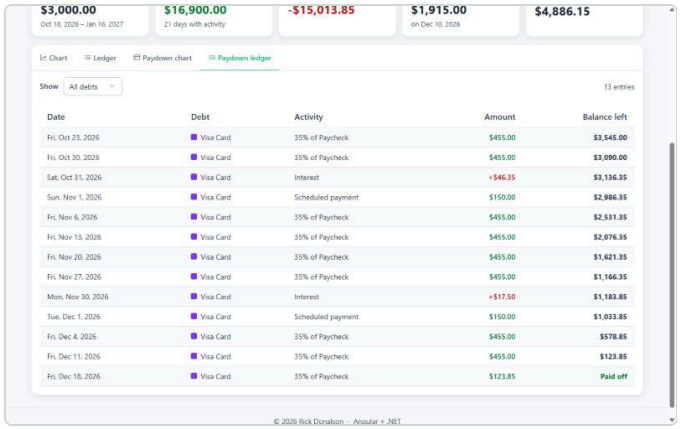


Editing a tracked debt

As with cards, a credit can't be split more than 100% across all your debts. The trash can on a card stops tracking that debt but keeps the debit. On Display, a tracked debt adds **Paydown chart** and **Paydown ledger** tabs.



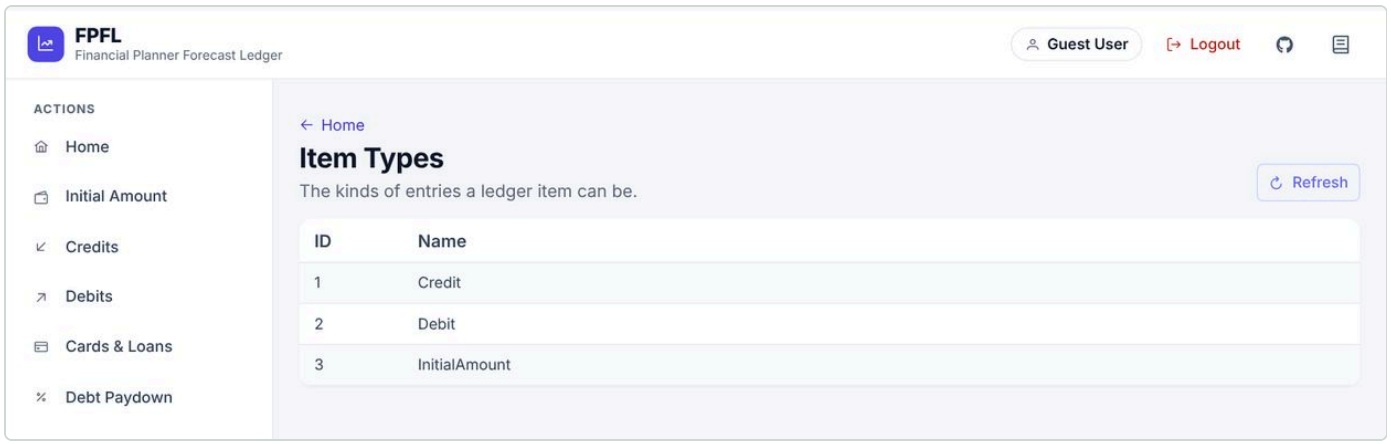
The Paydown chart tab



The Paydown ledger tab

Item types and time periods

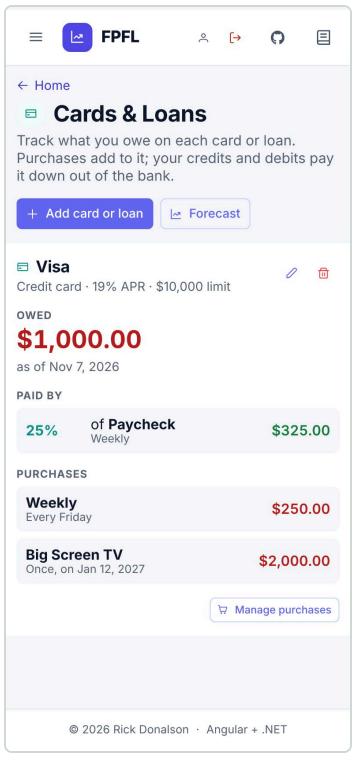
These reference lists define the kinds of items (Credit, Debit, Initial Amount) and the ten time periods. Only admins see them in the menu and can add, rename or delete entries; admins also get a **System Status** page with the health of the UI and the API.



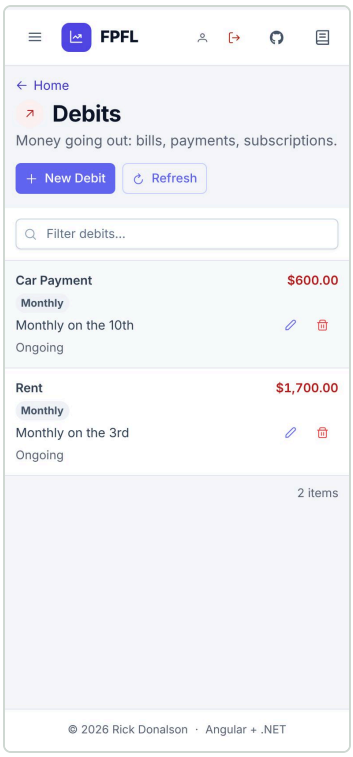
The Item Types list

On a phone

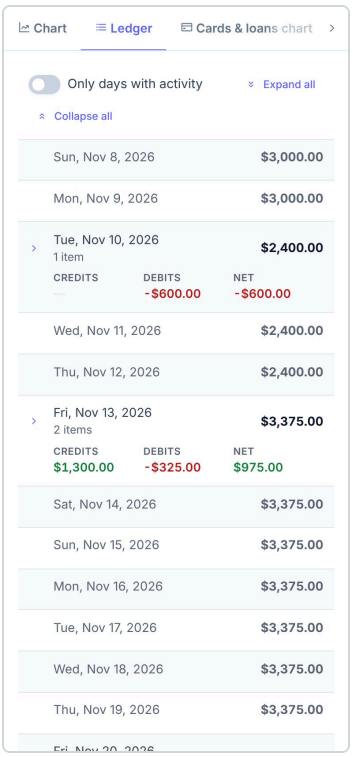
Every page fits a phone screen. Tables become stacked cards: an item's name and amount on top with its schedule below, and a ledger day as its date and balance with credits, debits and net underneath. The Display tabs scroll sideways when they don't all fit.



Cards & Loans



Debits



The ledger